CYNTHIA G. LAWRENCE (SBN 148927)
BRYAN L. MALONE (SBN 144082)
BLAZE VAN DINE (SBN 251946)
SIMS, LAWRENCE & BROGHAMMER
1478 Stone Point Drive, Suite 450
Roseville, CA 95661
Telephone: (916) 797-8881
Facsimile: (916) 253-1544
Email: cynthia@sims-law.net
bryan@sims-law.net
blaze@sims-law.net
SLB@sims-law.net

Attorneys for Defendant
KATIE PALACIOS and
HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION (sued and served as The Hope Program)

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA

COUNTY OF SAN JOAQUIN

BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI, Plaintiff, v. KATIE PALACIOS, Clinical Director, HOPE Program (Stockton, California), an individual; HOPE PSYCHOTHERAPY, INC., d/b/a HOPE PROGRAM, a California corporation; and DOES 1-10, inclusive, Defendants.	Case No.: STK-CV-UF-2026-0001032 **DEFENDANT HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION'S RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST SET OF FORM INTERROGATORIES** Complaint Filed: February 10, 2026 Trial Date: TBD

PROPOUNDING PARTY: Plaintiff BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI

RESPONDING PARTY: Defendant HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION

SET NO: ONE

Defendant HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION ("HOPE" or "Defendant" or "Responding Party") hereby

objects and responds to Plaintiff BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI's ("Propounding Party") First Set of Form Interrogatories, as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

The following responses are made solely for the purpose of this pending action. Documents eventually produced in response to the Interrogatories and any individual request therein, are subject to admissibility, as well as to any and all other objections on any grounds that would require the exclusion of any statement therein if the information were introduced in court. All objections and grounds for such objections are expressly reserved and may be interposed at the time of any motion or trial.

These responses are based on discovery available as of the date hereof. Discovery is continuing, and these responses are accordingly subject to revision. Further discovery, independent investigation, and analysis may supply additional facts and add meaning to known facts, as well as establish entirely new factual conclusions and legal contentions, all of which may lead to additions, changes to, or variations from the information set forth herein. These responses are given without prejudice to Defendant's right to produce, respond, or rely on subsequently discovered information, facts, or documents. Defendant accordingly reserves the right to change the response herein as additional facts are ascertained, analysis is made, legal research is completed, and contentions are made. The responses contained herein are made in a good faith effort to comply with the provisions of the California Rules of Civil Procedure but are in no way deemed to prejudice Defendant with respect to further discovery, research, and analysis.

GENERAL OBJECTIONS

1. Respondent objects to the Interrogatories to the extent that they seek information that is protected from disclosure by the attorney-client privilege, the attorney work product doctrine or any other recognized privilege.

2. Respondent objects to the Interrogatories to the extent that they require Respondent to search for and produce documents or information that are not within its possession, custody, or control.

3. Respondent objects to the Interrogatories to the extent they seek information or

documents that cannot be located by Respondent after reasonably diligent inquiry, are readily available from public sources, or are available to Plaintiff's counsel from another source or by other means that are more convenient, more appropriate, less burdensome, or less expensive.

4. Respondent objects to the Interrogatories to the extent they seek legal conclusions and/or would require Respondent to reach a legal conclusion in order to prepare a response.

5. Respondent objects to the Interrogatories to the extent they are argumentative, prejudicial, improper, incorrect, vague, and/or ambiguous.

6. Respondent objects to the Definitions to the extent that certain Definitions imply legal conclusions.

RESPONSES TO FORM INTERROGATORIES, SET ONE

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 1.1:

State the name, **ADDRESS**, telephone number, and relationship to you of each **PERSON** who prepared or assisted in the preparation of the responses to these interrogatories. (Do not identify anyone who simply typed or reproduced the responses.)

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 1.1:

Attorney Cynthia G. Lawrence, Sims, Lawrence & Broghammer, 1478 Stone Point Drive, Suite 450, Roseville, CA 95661; (916) 797-8881, counsel for defendant Hope Program, A Licensed Clinical Social Worker Professional Corporation who may be contacted through counsel.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.1:

Are you a corporation? If so, state:

a. the name stated in the current articles of incorporation;

b. all other names used by the corporation during the past 10 years and the dates each was used;

c. the date and place of incorporation;

d. the **ADDRESS** of the principal place of business; and

e. whether you are qualified to do business in California.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.1:

Yes.

a. HOPE Program, A Licensed Clinical Social Worker Professional Corporation;

b. HOPE Psychotherapy, Inc. (October 16, 2009 through May 26, 2017);

c. October 16, 2009, California;

d. 3170 Crow Canyon Place, Suite 135, San Ramon, CA 94583;

e. Yes.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.2:

Are you a partnership? If so, state:

a. the current partnership name;

b. all other names used by the partnership during the past 10 years and the dates each was used;

c. whether you are a limited partnership and, if so, under the laws of what jurisdiction;

d. the name and **ADDRESS** of each general partner; and

e. the **ADDRESS** of the principal place of business.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.2:

No.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.3:

Are you a limited liability company? If so, state:

a. the name stated in the current articles of organization;

b. all other names used by the company during the past 10 years and the dates each was used;

c. the date and place of filing of the articles of organization;

d. the **ADDRESS** of the principal place of business; and

e. whether you are qualified to do business in California.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.3:

No.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.4:

Are you a joint venture? If so, state:

a. the current joint venture name;

b. all other names used by the joint venture during the past 10 years and the dates each was

used;

c. the name and **ADDRESS** of each joint venturer; and

d. the **ADDRESS** of the principal place of business.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.4:

No.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.5:

Are you an unincorporated association? If so, state:

a. the current unincorporated association name;

b. all other names used by the unincorporated association during the past 10 years and the dates each was used; and

c. the **ADDRESS** of the principal place of business.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.5:

No.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.6:

Have you done business under a fictitious name during the past 10 years? If so, for each fictitious name state:

a. the name;

b. the dates each was used;

c. the state and county of each fictitious name filing; and

d. the **ADDRESS** of the principal place of business.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.6:

Yes.

a. HOPE Psychotherapy, Inc. from January 6, 2010 to January 6, 2015;

HOPE Program, A Licensed Clinical Social Worker Professional Corporation;

b. January 6, 2010 to January 6, 2015;

July 10, 2017 to present;

c. 3170 Crow Canyon Place, Suite 135, San Ramon, CA 94583.

///

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.7:

Within the past five years has any public entity registered or licensed your business? If so, for each license or registration:

a. identify the license or registration;

b. state the name of the public entity; and

c. state the dates of issuance and expiration.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 3.7:

Yes.

a. CASOMB

b. California Department of Health Care Services (DHCS)

c. Issued September 2008, certification renews every two years.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 4.1:

At the time of the **INCIDENT**, was there in effect any policy of insurance through which you were or might be insured in any manner (for example, primary, pro-rata, or excess liability coverage or medical expense coverage) for the damages, claims, or actions that have arisen out of the **INCIDENT**? If so, for each policy state:

a. the kind of coverage;

b. the name and **ADDRESS** of the insurance company;

c. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each named insured;

d. the policy number;

e. the limits of coverage for each type of coverage contained in the policy;

f. whether any reservation of rights or controversy or coverage dispute exists between you and the insurance company; and

g. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the custodian of the policy.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 4.1:

Yes.

a. Healthcare Professional Liability;

b. Philadelphia Insurance Companies, One Bala Plaza, Suite 100, Bala Cynwyd, PA 19004;

c. Hope Psychotherapy, Inc.; Shannon Smith c/o Soteria Solution LLC, 3170 Crow Canyon Place, Ste, 135, San Ramon, CA 94583;

d. PHCP-67968-15

e. $1 million / $5 million;

f. Yes; and

g. Hope Psychotherapy, Inc.; Shannon Smith c/o Soteria Solution LLC, 3170 Crow Canyon Place, Ste, 135, San Ramon, CA 94583.

a. Commercial General Liability;

b. Philadelphia Insurance Companies, One Bala Plaza, Suite 100, Bala Cynwyd, PA 19004;

c. Hope Program, a Licensed Clinical Social Worker Professional Corporation, c/o Almax Consulting, LLC, 3170 Crow Canyon Place, #135, Hayward, CA 94583-2182

d. PHSD1838240-007

e. $1 million / $1 million

f. No; and

g. Hope Program, a Licensed Clinical Social Worker Professional Corporation, c/o Almax Consulting, LLC, 3170 Crow Canyon Place, #135, Hayward, CA 94583-2182.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 4.2:

Are you self-insured under any statute for the damages, claims, or actions that have arisen out of the **INCIDENT**? If so, specify the statute.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 4.2:

No.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.1:

State the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each individual:

a. who witnessed the **INCIDENT** or the events occurring immediately before or after the **INCIDENT**;

b. who made any statement at the scene of the **INCIDENT**;

c. who heard any statements made about the **INCIDENT** by any individual at the scene; and

d. who **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** claim has knowledge of the **INCIDENT** (except for expert witnesses covered by Code of Civil Procedure section 2034).

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.1:

Objection. Defendant objects to this interrogatory to the extent it seeks to violate the attorney-client and work product privileges and, further, seeks information prepared in anticipation of litigation. *Nacht & Lewis Architects, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal App 214, 271.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Individuals who may have knowledge of the INCIDENT as defined by Propounding Party are Katie Palacios, Bernadette Marie Tassone, both of whom can be reached through counsel, and CDCR/DAPO employees who participated in the Containment Team Meetings:

Glenn Urea, 612 Carlton Ave., Stockton, CA 95203 (209) 948-7652;

David Arestad, 612 Carlton Ave., Stockton, CA 95203 (209) 948-7652;

Derrick Andrew, 612 Carlton Ave., Stockton, CA 95203 (209) 948-7652;

Gary Noguchi, 612 Carlton Ave., Stockton, CA 95203 (209) 948-7652;

Madri Sherman, 612 Carlton Ave., Stockton, CA 95203 (209) 948-7652.

Discovery is ongoing and Responding Party reserves the right to amend its response upon the discovery of new facts and information.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.2:

Have **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** interviewed any individual concerning the **INCIDENT**? If so, for each individual state:

a. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual interviewed;

b. the date of the interview; and

c. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the **PERSON** who conducted the interview.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.2:

Responding Party objects to this request as seeking information protected by the attorney client and attorney work product privileges. (See *Payless Drug v. Superior Court* (1976) 54 Cal.App.3d 988,

Travelers Insurance Company v. Superior Court (1983) 143 Cal.App.3d 436, *Nacht & Lewis, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal.App.4th 214; and *Coito v. Superior Court* (2012) 54 Cal.4th 480.) Subject to and without waiving said objections, no.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.3:

Have **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** obtained a written or recorded statement from any individual concerning the **INCIDENT**? If so, for each statement state:

a. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual from whom the statement was obtained;

b. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual who obtained the statement;

c. the date the statement was obtained; and

d. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the original statement or a copy.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.3:

Objection. Defendant objects to this interrogatory to the extent it seeks to violate the attorney-client and work product privileges and, further, seeks information prepared in anticipation of litigation. *Nacht & Lewis Architects, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal App 214, 271. Defendant further objects to this interrogatory on the ground that it is unintelligible based upon this responding defendant's understanding of the term "INCIDENT" as it relates to this matter. Responding Party cannot determine which alleged event(s) set forth in plaintiffs' Complaint this interrogatory is referring to and invites a meet and confer with plaintiff.

Without waiving objections, Responding Party responds as follows: No. Discovery is continuing.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.4:

Do **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** know of any photographs, films, or videotapes depicting any place, object, or individual concerning the **INCIDENT** or plaintiff's injuries? If so, state:

a. the number of photographs or feet of film or videotape;

b. the places, objects, or persons photographed, filmed, or videotaped;

c. the date the photographs, films, or videotapes were taken;

d. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual taking the photographs, films, or videotapes; and

e. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the original or a copy of the photographs, films, or videotapes.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.4:

Objection. Defendant objects to this interrogatory to the extent it seeks to violate the attorney-client and work product privileges and, further, seeks information prepared in anticipation of litigation. *Nacht & Lewis Architects, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal App 214, 271. Defendant further objects to this interrogatory on the ground that it is unintelligible based upon this responding defendant's understanding of the term "INCIDENT" as it relates to this matter. Responding party cannot determine which alleged event(s) set forth in plaintiffs' Complaint this interrogatory is referring to and invites a meet and confer with plaintiff.

Subject to and without waving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Yes, Containment Team Meetings are video recorded.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.5:

Do **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** know of any diagram, reproduction, or model of any place or thing (except for items developed by expert witnesses covered by Code of Civil Procedure sections 2034.210–2034.310) concerning the **INCIDENT**? If so, for each item state:

a. the type (i.e., diagram, reproduction, or model);

b. the subject matter; and

c. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has it.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.5:

Objection. Defendant objects to this interrogatory to the extent it seeks to violate the attorney-client and work product privileges and, further, seeks information prepared in anticipation of litigation. *Nacht & Lewis Architects, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal App 214, 271.

Subject to and without waving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: No. Discovery is continuing.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.6:

Was a report made by any **PERSON** concerning the **INCIDENT**? If so, state:

a. the name, title, identification number, and employer of the **PERSON** who made the report;

b. the date and type of report made;

c. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of **PERSON** for whom the report was made; and

d. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the original or a copy of the report.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.6:

Objection. Defendant objects to this interrogatory to the extent it seeks to violate the attorney-client and work product privileges and, further, seeks information prepared in anticipation of litigation. *Nacht & Lewis Architects, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal App 214, 271. Defendant further objects to this interrogatory on the ground that it is unintelligible based upon this responding defendant's understanding of the term "INCIDENT" as it relates to this matter. Responding Party cannot determine which alleged event(s) set forth in plaintiffs' Complaint this interrogatory is referring to and invites a meet and confer with plaintiff.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.7:

Have **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** inspected the scene of the **INCIDENT**? If so, for each inspection state:

a. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual making the inspection (except for expert witnesses covered by Code of Civil Procedure sections 2034.210–2034.310); and

b. the date of the inspection.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 12.7:

Objection. Defendant objects to this interrogatory to the extent it seeks to violate the attorney-

client and work product privileges and, further, seeks information prepared in anticipation of litigation. *Nacht & Lewis Architects, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal App 214, 271. Defendant further objects to this interrogatory on the ground that it is unintelligible based upon this responding defendant's understanding of the term "INCIDENT" as it relates to this matter. Responding Party cannot determine which alleged event(s) set forth in plaintiffs' Complaint this interrogatory is referring to and invites a meet and confer with plaintiff.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 13.1:

Have **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** conducted surveillance of any individual involved in the **INCIDENT** or any party to this action? If so, for each surveillance state:

a. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual or party;

b. the time, date, and place of the surveillance;

c. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual who conducted the surveillance; and

d. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the original or a copy of any surveillance photograph, film, or videotape.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 13.1:

Objection. Defendant objects to this interrogatory to the extent it seeks to violate the attorney-client and work product privileges and, further, seeks information prepared in anticipation of litigation. *Nacht & Lewis Architects, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal App 214, 271. Defendant further objects to this interrogatory on the ground that it is unintelligible based upon this responding defendant's understanding of the term "INCIDENT" as it relates to this matter. Responding party cannot determine which alleged event(s) set forth in plaintiffs' Complaint this interrogatory is referring to and invites a meet and confer with plaintiff.

Without waiving objections, Responding Party responds as follows: No.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 13.2:

Has a written report been prepared on the surveillance? If so, for each written report state:

a. the title;

b. the date;

c. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the individual who prepared the report; and

d. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the original or a copy.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 13.2:

Not applicable. See response to 13.1, supra.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 14.1:

Do **YOU OR ANYONE ACTING ON YOUR BEHALF** contend that any **PERSON** involved in the **INCIDENT** violated any statute, ordinance, or regulation and that the violation was a legal (proximate) cause of the **INCIDENT**? If so, identify the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** and the statute, ordinance, or regulation that was violated.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 14.1:

Responding Party objects to this interrogatory on the basis that it seeks information obtained in anticipation of litigation and is protected by the attorney client and attorney work product privileges. (See *Payless Drug v. Superior Court* (1976) 54 Cal.App.3d 988; *Travelers Insurance Company v. Superior Court* (1983) 143 Cal.App.3d 436; *Nacht & Lewis, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal.App.4th 214; and *Coito v. Superior Court* (2012) 54 Cal.App.4th 480.) Subject to and without waiving the aforementioned objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Not to this Responding Party's knowledge.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 14.2:

Was any **PERSON** cited or charged with a violation of any statute, ordinance, or regulation as a result of this **INCIDENT**? If so, for each **PERSON** state:

a. the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the **PERSON**;

b. the statute, ordinance, or regulation allegedly violated;

c. whether the **PERSON** entered a plea in response to the citation or charge and, if so, the plea entered; and

d. the name and **ADDRESS** of the court or administrative agency, names of the parties, and case number.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 14.2:

Defendant objects to this interrogatory on the grounds that it is unintelligible based upon this responding defendant's understanding of the term "INCIDENT" as it relates to this matter. Responding Party cannot determine which alleged event(s) set forth in plaintiffs' Complaint. Notwithstanding this objection, the following response is provided. No.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 15.1:

Identify each denial of a material allegation and each special or affirmative defense in your pleadings and for each:

a. state all facts upon which you base the denial or special or affirmative defense;

b. state the names, **ADDRESSES**, and telephone numbers of all **PERSONS** who have knowledge of those facts; and

c. identify all **DOCUMENTS** and other tangible things that support your denial or special or affirmative defense, and state the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the **PERSON** who has each **DOCUMENT**.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 15.1:

Responding Party objects to the above interrogatory on the grounds that it seeks the disclosure of private information of third parties protected by California case law and the California Constitution. Responding Party objects to this interrogatory on the basis that it seeks information obtained in anticipation of litigation and is protected by the attorney client and attorney work product privileges. (See *Payless Drug v. Superior Court* (1976) 54 Cal.App.3d 988; *Travelers Insurance Company v. Superior Court* (1983) 143 Cal.App.3d 436; *Nacht & Lewis, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1996) 47 Cal.App.4th 214; and *Coito v. Superior Court* (2012) 54 Cal.App.4th 480.) Responding Party further objects as the above interrogatory is overbroad and is premature as discovery has just commenced.

This interrogatory seeks to have Responding Party's counsel reveal its thought processes, what evidence it believes is important and/or unimportant to Responding Party's defenses, as well as counsel's assessment of the strength and weaknesses of plaintiff's' case. Responding Party does not have the obligation to disclose these thought processes, assessments and evaluations and essentially

disclose Responding Party's case and prepare plaintiffs or other parties' cases for them. (See *Sav-On Drugs, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1975) 15Cal.3d 1, 5.)

Subject to and without waiving these objections, this answering Responding Party responds as follows: This answering Responding Party's preliminary allegations, affirmative defenses and denials were pled at the outset of this case before Responding Party began its investigation of the matter. This answering Responding Party's allegations, responsive pleadings and affirmative defenses were made in order to avoid waiver. This answering Responding Party's investigation and discovery into this matter are incomplete. Consequently, it is impossible at this time to state all facts upon which this Responding Party bases its preliminary allegations, special or affirmative defenses and denials. Further, the documents and identities of persons with knowledge of facts supporting this Responding Party's denials and affirmative defenses are not completely known at this time. Additional investigation and discovery are necessary before all of the referenced facts, documents, and persons can be fully ascertained and provided. At this time, this Responding Party does not have sufficient information and/or documentation and/or tangible things in its possession to fully and completely respond to this interrogatory.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 17.1:

Is your response to each request for admission served with these interrogatories an unqualified admission? If not, for each response that is not an unqualified admission:

a. state the number of the request;

b. state all facts upon which you base your response;

c. state the names, **ADDRESSES**, and telephone numbers of all **PERSONS** who have knowledge of the facts; and

d. identify all **DOCUMENTS** and other tangible things that support your contention, and state the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of the **PERSON** who has each **DOCUMENT** or thing.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 17.1:

a. Request for Admission No. 5.

b. During the RELEVANT PERIOD, HOPE has determined that multiple clients

(parolees) at the STOCKTON FACILITY successfully completed sex-offender treatment prior to that client's discharge from parole.

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen, Dr. Carrie Shinske, Dr. Drew Kingston —available through counsel.

d. Responding Party objects to this interrogatory on the grounds that it seeks information protected by the constitutional right to privacy under Article I, section 1 of the California Constitution, including confidential, sensitive, and private information belonging to non-parties. *See Younger v. Berkeley City Council* (1975) 45 Cal.App.3d 825, 832. The interrogatory is not narrowly tailored, is overbroad as to time, scope, and persons covered, and seeks private information that is not directly relevant to the claims or defenses in this action. Plaintiff has not demonstrated a compelling need for disclosure sufficient to outweigh the affected privacy interests. Responding Party further objects that any disclosure of such information, if ordered, should be limited to information directly relevant to the claims and defenses, redacted as appropriate, subject to notice to affected persons if required, and governed by an appropriate protective order.

a. Request for Admission No. 6.b.

b. Pursuant to HOPE's four-phase program structure (preparatory, core, maintenance, aftercare) clients who have completed the Maintenance Phase of treatment are placed in HOPE's Aftercare Program.

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen, Dr. Carrie Shinske, Dr. Drew Kingston —available through counsel.

d. Upon the entry of a protective order, documents produced in response to Plaintiff's Request for Production of Documents, Nos. 1-3.

a. Request for Admission No. 7.

b. Pursuant to HOPE's policies and practices a client may complete sex-offender treatment prior to that parolee's discharge from parole. Prior to October of 2024 CDCR required continuous treatment during active parole

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen, Dr. Carrie Shinske, Dr. Drew Kingston —available through counsel.

d. https://www.cdcr.ca.gov/regulations/wp-content/uploads/sites/171/2024/10/2024-0924-02EON-SOT-Approval.pdf

a. Request for Admission No. 8

b. In October of 2024, HOPE modified its treatment-completion policies or practices for parolee participants in response to the CDCR policy change making aftercare voluntary for clients who have completed treatment.

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen, Dr. Carrie Shinske, Dr. Drew Kingston —available through counsel.

d. Upon the entry of a protective order, documents produced in response to Plaintiff's Request for Production of Documents, Nos. 1-3.

a. Request for Admission No. 14.

b. HOPE is not "aware of the DWYER order", other than Plaintiff's reference to it in this litigation.

c. Not applicable.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 15.

b. To HOPE's knowledge PALACIOS did not state that "HOPE 'routinely loses client homework packets', or words to that effect."

c. Katie Palacios.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 16.

b. To HOPE's knowledge it has not lost, misplaced, destroyed, or been unable to locate one or more homework packets submitted by PLAINTIFF during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

c. Katie Palacios, Kristen Hansen, available through counsel.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 19.

b. To HOPE's knowledge it has a complete and accurate record of every homework packet submitted by PLAINTIFF to HOPE during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

c. Kristine Hansen, available through counsel.

d. Hope Program Curriculum Tracking.

a. Request for Admission No. 21.

b. HOPE would receive payment for services rendered in participating in the process of a client's treatment-completion determination.

c. Kristine Hansen.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 23.

b. To HOPE's knowledge, PALACIOS did not state at the August 2025 CTM that Plaintiff's behavior was "abhorrent" or that he was "often disrespectful".

c. Katie Palacios, available through counsel.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 24.

b. To HOPE's knowledge, PALACIOS did not characterize PLAINTIFF'S respectful demeanor at the August 2025 CTM as an "acting job".

c. Katie Palacios, available through counsel.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 26.

b. HOPE was not aware as of February 2022 that PLAINTIFF held a Class A Commercial Driver's License (CDL).

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen—available through counsel.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 27.

b. HOPE is not aware that in or about February 2022, PLAINTIFF disclosed to HOPE clinician Pamela Akins that he was working for Keurig Dr. Pepper as a CLD driver.

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen—available through counsel.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 28.

b. HOPE was not aware that PLAINTIFF's CDLL employment required flexible scheduling, the ability to travel outside the Stockton region, and the ability to accept long-haul assignments.

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen—available through counsel.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 30.

b. HOPE cannot speculate as to what "caused CDCR/DAPO to maintain GPS monitoring, curfew, and geographic restrictions on PLAINTIFF that limited his ability to accept long-haul CDL assignments."

c. Katie Palacios, Kristine Hansen, Dr. Carrie Shinske, Dr. Drew Kingston —available through counsel.

d. Not applicable.

a. Request for Admission No. 31.

b. 15 C.C.R. § 3574(f)(1), effective April 17, 2025, reads "Pursuant to Section 3573, a Level of Service or Case Management Inventory (LS/CMI) score of 11 or higher."

c. Not applicable.

d. Not applicable.

FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 50.1:

For each agreement alleged in the pleadings:

a. identify each **DOCUMENT** that is part of the agreement and for each state the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the **DOCUMENT**;

b. state each part of the agreement not in writing, the name, ADDRESS, and telephone number of each **PERSON** agreeing to that provision, and the date that part of the agreement was made;

c. identify all **DOCUMENTS** that evidence any part of the agreement not in writing and for each state the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the **DOCUMENT**;

d. identify all **DOCUMENTS** that are part of any modification to the agreement, and for

each state the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the **DOCUMENT**;

e. state each modification not in writing, the date, and the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** agreeing to the modification, and the date the modification was made;

f. identify all **DOCUMENTS** that evidence any modification of the agreement not in writing and for each state the name, **ADDRESS**, and telephone number of each **PERSON** who has the **DOCUMENT**.

RESPONSE TO FORM INTERROGATORY NO. 50.1:

Responding Party objects as the above interrogatory as premature pursuant to the instructions for these interrogatories, specifically Section 2 (d). Responding Party objects on the ground that the above interrogatory calls for the premature disclosure of expert opinions. Subject to and without waiving the foregoing objections, Responding Party responds:

Responding Party does not have enough information to respond at this time.

Dated: June 15, 2026

SIMS, LAWRENCE & BROGHAMMER

By: Cynthia G. Lawrence

CYNTHIA G. LAWRENCE
BRYAN L. MALONE
BLAZE VAN DINE
Attorneys for Defendants,
KATIE PALACIOS and
HOPE PROGRAM

VERIFICATION

Newanforbi v. Palacios

I, Carrie Shinske, state and declare:

I am the Executive Director, Clinical Operations of HOPE Program, A Licensed Clinical Social Worker Professional Corporation, a Defendant in the above-entitled matter, and I am authorized to execute this Verification on its behalf. I have read the foregoing Responses to Plaintiff's First Set of Form Interrogatories and know the contents thereof. I am informed and believe, and on that ground, I allege the matters stated therein are true.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed at San Diego, California, on June 12, 2026.

Carrie Shinske (Jun 12, 2026 17:42:59 PDT)

CARRIE SHINSKE

PROOF OF SERVICE

I, Kim Schmitt, certify and declare as follows:

I am over the age of 18 years, and not a party to this action. My business address is 1478 Stone Point Drive, Suite 450, Roseville, CA 95661. My business email is: kschmitt@sims-law.net. I am employed in the County of Placer where this service occurs.

On the date set forth below, following ordinary business practice, I served a true copy of the foregoing document(s) described as:

DEFENDANT HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION'S RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST SET OF FORM INTERROGATORIES

☐ (BY MAIL) I am readily familiar with my employer's normal business practice for collection and processing of correspondence for mailing with the U.S. Postal Service. Correspondence so collected and processed is deposited with the U.S. Postal Service that same day in the ordinary course of business. I placed for deposit in the United States Postal Service in a sealed envelope, with postage fully prepaid, to the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY PERSONAL SERVICE) I personally delivered the above document(s) by hand between 9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. to the office of the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY OVERNIGHT DELIVERY) I deposited in a box or other facility regularly maintained by Federal Express an express service carrier, or delivered to a courier or driver authorized by said express service carrier to receive such envelope(s) to be delivered by overnight delivery, with delivery fees paid or provided for, addressed to the person(s) on whom it is to be served below.

☒ (BY ELECTRONIC SERVICE) I transmitted via electronic service through electronic mail to the offices of the addressee(s) below as stated on the attached service list on this date before 5:00 p.m.

SEE ATTACHED SERVICE LIST

☒ (State) I certify and declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on: June 15, 2026

Kim Schmitt

SERVICE LIST

Brendan Ngehsi Newanforbi Plaintiff, in Pro Per 1455 Cat Tail Drive Stockton, CA 95204 (209) 801-4442 E: bnn.cdl@gmail.com	**PLAINTIFF, IN PER**